

The Library Book

Grade 2

Name: _____ Date: _____

Maya's library book was due the next morning. She checked her backpack, her desk, and the couch. She looked in the kitchen and by the front door. The book was not in any of those places.

Before bed, Maya got on the floor and looked under the bed. The book was beside a stuffed dog. She brushed off the dust and slid the book into her backpack so she would not forget it.

At school, Maya gave the book to the librarian before class began. The librarian smiled and said it was right on time. Maya felt proud as she walked to class.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

The Popped Ball

Grade 2

Name: _____ Date: _____

Leo was practicing shots in the gym when his kick sent the ball into a chair leg. The ball popped and hissed. Leo froze. He knew the class needed that ball for games.

Leo picked up the flat ball and walked it to Coach Ramirez. He told the truth and said he was sorry. Coach handed him tape, and Leo pressed it over the hole so the class could still roll the ball. After school, Coach brought a new ball from the office.

Leo thanked him and promised to aim away from the chairs. The next shot stayed on the gym floor.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Ruby Gets Out

Grade 2

Name: _____ Date: _____

Nina was the class helper for Ruby the rabbit. She latched the hutch, or so she thought. At reading time, a student whispered that Ruby was on the rug.

Nina closed the classroom door so Ruby could not hop into the hall. She looked under the reading shelves and behind the paint jars. At last she found Ruby sitting in a box of paper scraps. Nina lifted her gently and set her back in the hutch. This time she checked the latch twice.

Ruby nibbled her hay. Nina told the teacher what had happened, and they added a second clip to the door.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

The Forgotten Lunch

Grade 2

Name: _____ Date: _____

Jay sat down at lunch and unzipped his backpack. His lunch bag was not there. His stomach growled, and the cafeteria line was already closed.

His friend Elena opened her lunch and split the sandwich and the apple slices. Jay ate slowly and said thank you. At recess he helped Elena carry the ball bag out to the field.

The next morning Jay packed his own lunch and put an extra cheese stick on top for Elena. He zipped the backpack and checked the pocket twice before he left home. Elena smiled at lunch when she saw the extra snack in her hand.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

The Drooping Plant

Grade 2

Name: _____ Date: _____

Priya's bean plant sat on a high shelf in the classroom. One Monday the stem bent over and the leaves looked soft. Priya was afraid the plant was dying.

She asked the teacher if they could move it. Together they set the pot on the sunny windowsill. Priya gave the soil a small drink of water, but she did not flood it. She wrote the date on a card beside the pot.

By Wednesday the stem had lifted and the leaves felt firmer. Priya smiled and kept the plant in the sun. She checked the soil with her finger each morning.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

The Paper Crown

Grade 2

Name: _____

Date: _____

Omar was the king in the class play. Five minutes before the show, the paper crown was not on the prop table. He checked the costume bin and the music stand. No crown.

His partner, Lila, grabbed yellow paper and tape. They cut a band, taped it to fit Omar's head, and drew three paper jewels. It was simple, but it looked bright under the lights.

Omar walked on stage wearing the new crown. He remembered his lines, and the class clapped. After the play he saved the crown in his folder. He showed it to his family at home that night.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Mixed-Up Puzzle

Grade 2

Name: _____ Date: _____

Ana had almost finished a puzzle of a red barn. Her little brother Mateo ran through the room and bumped the table. Pieces slid onto the rug and mixed with the ones still in the box.

Ana took a breath instead of yelling. She and Mateo picked up every piece. Ana sorted the edge pieces into a pile, and Mateo stacked the red ones. They rebuilt the border first.

They worked until the barn door clicked into place. Mateo clapped. Ana let him put in the last piece. They left the finished barn on the table for the rest of the day.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Diego and his uncle spread a blanket in the park and set out watermelon, rolls, and cheese. A line of ants crossed the blanket and headed for the watermelon.

Diego waved his hands, but more ants came. His uncle said they should move. They packed the food into closed tubs, shook the blanket, and carried everything to a picnic table in the sun.

Diego wiped the table, and they ate there. The ants stayed in the grass. Diego kept the tubs shut between bites. His uncle said the picnic table had been the better spot all along, and Diego agreed with him.

Setting**Character****Beginning (State Problem)****Middle (Three Events)**

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

The Slipped Chain

Grade 2

Name: _____ Date: _____

Rosa was riding home when her bike chain slipped off the front gears. The pedals spun, but the bike would not move. She walked it to the sidewalk so cars could pass.

Her neighbor, Mr. Brooks, was washing his car. He showed Rosa how to lift the chain with a stick and set it back on the small gear. Rosa tried once and missed. She tried again, slowly, and the chain caught.

She pedaled down the driveway and back. The chain stayed on. Rosa thanked Mr. Brooks and rode the rest of the way home. She checked the chain once more at the corner.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____ Date: _____

The classroom fish tank looked like fog. Ben could barely see the three fish. He noticed extra flakes floating on top, left from a feeding he had done at lunch.

Ben told Ms. Patel. She said too much food can make the water cloudy. Ben scooped out the extra flakes with a net. Then Ms. Patel helped him replace some of the water with fresh water from a bucket.

The next morning the tank was clearer, and the fish swam near the glass. Ben taped a feeding chart on the tank so no one would feed them twice. The fish kept swimming in the clear water.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Elena could not read the board. Her glasses were gone. She checked her desk, the library bin, and the gym office. She was starting to worry she would miss the spelling test.

At recess she pulled on her hoodie because of the wind. Something hard tapped her elbow. She reached into the front pocket and felt the case. The glasses were inside, folded and safe.

Elena put them on and the trees looked sharp again. She went back to class, told her teacher, and finished the test. From then on she clipped the case to her backpack. She did not want to hunt for them again.

Setting**Character****Beginning (State Problem)****Middle (Three Events)**

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Malik was flying a red kite at the park when a gust dropped it into an oak tree. The string tangled in the branches. Malik tugged, and the kite only tipped sideways.

His older sister, Noor, found a long lightweight pole by the garden shed. She lifted the string, and Malik held the kite so it would not rip. The loop slid free.

They walked to the open field, away from the trees. Malik sent the kite up again. This time he kept his eyes on the branches and let out string slowly. The kite stayed high in the open sky.

Setting**Character****Beginning (State Problem)****Middle (Three Events)**

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Lucy noticed that Pip the hamster was curled in a tight ball. His cage sat under the heating vent, and cold air poured on the bedding whenever the fan clicked on.

Lucy told Mr. Chen. They moved the cage to a quiet shelf away from the vent. Lucy added a handful of soft bedding and a cardboard hut. Pip crept inside and his breathing looked calmer.

Lucy checked him after lunch. Pip was running on the wheel. Mr. Chen wrote "Keep away from the vent" on a card and taped it above the shelf. Pip stayed warm for the rest of the day.

Setting**Character****Beginning (State Problem)****Middle (Three Events)**

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

The Smudged Painting

Grade 2

Name: _____ Date: _____

Andre had spent all art class on a painting of the playground. As he carried the wet paper to the drying rack, his sleeve dragged across the sky. A gray smear covered the sun.

Andre wanted to throw it away. Ms. Brooks said to wait until it dried and then decide. When the paper was dry, Andre looked again. The smear could be a cloud.

He painted soft edges around it and added two smaller clouds. The playground looked stormy and interesting. Andre hung the painting in the hall with his name on a card. Classmates stopped to look at the stormy sky.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

The Permission Slip

Grade 2

Name: _____ Date: _____

Sofia's class was going to the science museum, but her permission slip was missing on the day it was due. She dumped her folder on the kitchen table. Old drawings fell out. No slip.

She and her dad checked the backpack pockets and the mail pile. Dad opened the kitchen drawer where they kept pencils. The slip was under a pad of paper, still blank.

Dad signed it. Sofia put it in a folder and zipped that folder into the front pocket. The next morning she handed it to her teacher and got her name on the trip list. Sofia grinned.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Noah was new and sat alone on the bench at recess. Camila's team needed another player for kickball. She walked over and asked if he wanted to play.

Noah said he did not know the rules. Camila explained them in three short steps: kick, run, and tag the base. She let him bat second so he could watch once.

Noah kicked a soft ground ball and reached first base. His team cheered. The next day he came to the bench smiling, and Camila saved him a spot in the line. Noah said the game was the best part of his school day.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Hector was in charge of the cookie sale. He counted the boxes on the table and came up two short. The customers in line were waiting, and he did not want to sell treats he could not hand over.

He checked the supply closet and the teacher's desk. Then he looked behind the counter. Two boxes had slid against the wall, hidden by a poster board.

Hector set them on the table and counted again. The number matched his list. He sold the cookies, wrote the total, and pushed the extra boxes forward so none could hide. The line moved, and no one left without a box.

Setting**Character****Beginning (State Problem)****Middle (Three Events)**

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Amina's dog, Bean, ran and hid whenever the vacuum started. On Saturday Amina needed to clean her room, but Bean was shaking behind the bed.

Amina turned the vacuum off. She let Bean sniff the silent machine and gave him a calm pat. Then she turned it on in the hall, far from him, and tossed his ball so he had something else to think about.

Bean stayed in the doorway instead of running. Amina vacuumed a small square of rug and stopped. The next Saturday Bean watched from his bed. He still disliked the noise, but he did not hide.

Setting**Character****Beginning (State Problem)****Middle (Three Events)**

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

The Empty Feeder

Grade 2

Name: _____ Date: _____

Jonah looked out at the backyard and saw the bird feeder hanging empty. The chickadees landed, peeked in, and flew off. He had forgotten to fill it after the last storm.

He poured seed into a cup, carried it outside, and filled the feeder to the line his mom had marked. He latched the lid so squirrels would have a harder time. Then he stood back by the window.

Within a few minutes the chickadees returned. Jonah watched them take turns on the perch. He wrote "Fill feeder" on the family calendar so it would not sit empty again. Jonah smiled at the full perch.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)

The Ripped Poster

Grade 2

Name: _____ Date: _____

Lila's group had finished a poster about the water cycle. On the morning of the presentation, she found a rip through the sentence about clouds. The corner of the poster had caught on a chair.

Lila did not try to hide it. She turned the poster over, and her partners held it flat while she pressed tape along the rip. Then she wrote the torn sentence again in neat letters above the tape.

When they presented, the poster stayed together. The class could read every word. Lila kept a roll of tape in the project box after that. The group felt ready to present.

Setting

Character

Beginning (State Problem)

Middle (Three Events)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Ending (Solution)